Check List

1. The "Receive" Myth (UPI Safety)

Never enter your **UPI PIN** or scan a **QR Code** to "receive" money. In the UPI ecosystem, entering a PIN is *only* for sending money or checking your balance. If a "buyer" on OLX or a stranger says they are sending you a refund and asks for your PIN, it is 100% a scam.

2. Verify the VPA Name (UPI Safety)

Before hitting 'Send' on any UPI app (PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm), always **verify the name** that appears after scanning. Fraudsters often use fake posters with different names or slightly altered UPI IDs to divert your payments.

3. The "Free WiFi" Trap

Avoid logging into your bank accounts, student portals, or even your Instagram while on free public WiFi at railway stations or cafes. If you must use it, use a **reputable VPN** to encrypt your data, as these networks are prime spots for "man-in-the-middle" attacks.

4. Internship & Job Offer Audit

Be extremely wary of "Congratulations!" messages on WhatsApp or Telegram offering part-time jobs for "liking videos" or "rating hotels." **Legitimate companies will never ask you for a 'registration fee' or 'security deposit'** to start an internship.

5. Lock Your Social Profiles

With the rise of AI-generated deepfakes and profile cloning, ensure your Instagram/Facebook profiles are set to **Private**. Limit who can see your "Followers" list and "Tagged" photos to prevent scammers from harvesting your personal details to impersonate you.

6. Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

Enable 2FA on your WhatsApp, Gmail, and Instagram immediately. Use an **Authenticator App** (like Google or Microsoft Authenticator) rather than SMS, as "SIM Swapping" is a common tactic used to bypass text-based codes.

7. Link & File Scrutiny

Never click on links in SMS messages claiming your "Electricity will be disconnected" or your "Bank account is blocked." These are **Phishing** attempts. If you receive an unexpected PDF or APK file from a classmate or "professor" on WhatsApp, verify it via a phone call before opening.

8. App Permissions Clean-up

Periodically check which apps have access to your **Microphone, Camera, and Contacts**. Many "loan apps" or "photo editors" frequently used by students are actually spyware designed to steal your contact list for extortion.

🚨 How to Report Cyber Crime

If you have been scammed or are facing online harassment, **every minute counts.**

- **Official Portal:** Report immediately at cybercrime.gov.in.
- **National Helpline:** Call **1930** (available 24/7) to report financial fraud.
    - *Pro-tip:* Reporting within the "Golden Hour" (the first 1-2 hours) significantly increases the chances of the bank freezing the scammer's account and recovering your money.